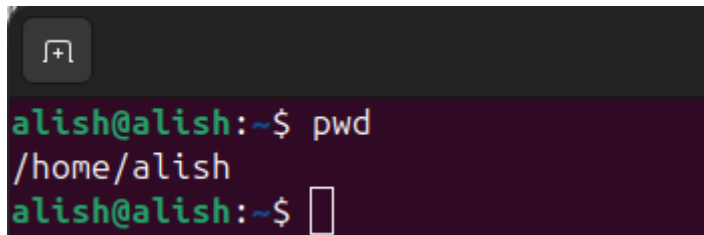


Title: Basic Linux Command

1. pwd

(Print working directory) displays the full path of the current directory we are in.

Command : pwd

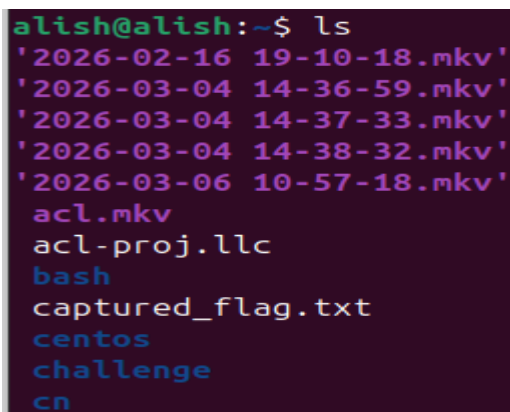
A terminal window with a dark background. The prompt is 'alish@alish:~\$'. The command 'pwd' is entered. The output is '/home/alish'. The prompt is now 'alish@alish:~\$' followed by a cursor.

```
alish@alish:~$ pwd
/home/alish
alish@alish:~$
```

2. ls

List all files and directory in the current location.

Command: ls

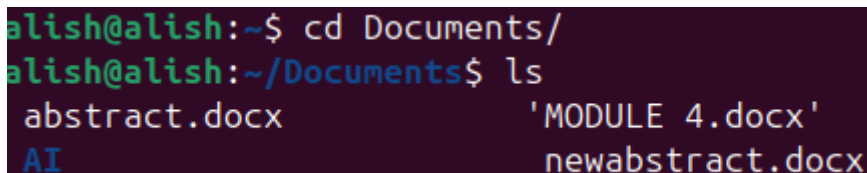
A terminal window with a dark background. The prompt is 'alish@alish:~\$'. The command 'ls' is entered. The output lists several files and directories: '2026-02-16 19-10-18.mkv', '2026-03-04 14-36-59.mkv', '2026-03-04 14-37-33.mkv', '2026-03-04 14-38-32.mkv', '2026-03-06 10-57-18.mkv', 'acl.mkv', 'acl-proj.llc', 'bash', 'captured_flag.txt', 'centos', 'challenge', and 'cn'.

```
alish@alish:~$ ls
'2026-02-16 19-10-18.mkv'
'2026-03-04 14-36-59.mkv'
'2026-03-04 14-37-33.mkv'
'2026-03-04 14-38-32.mkv'
'2026-03-06 10-57-18.mkv'
acl.mkv
acl-proj.llc
bash
captured_flag.txt
centos
challenge
cn
```

3. cd (change directory)

Used to navigate between the folders (cd Document,cd Download)

Command : cd Document

A terminal window with a dark background. The prompt is 'alish@alish:~\$'. The command 'cd Documents/' is entered. The prompt changes to 'alish@alish:~/Documents\$'. The command 'ls' is entered. The output lists files: 'abstract.docx', 'AI', 'MODULE 4.docx', and 'newabstract.docx'.

```
alish@alish:~$ cd Documents/
alish@alish:~/Documents$ ls
abstract.docx      'MODULE 4.docx'
AI                 newabstract.docx
```

4. mkdir (make directory)

Creates a new folder or a directory

Command: mkdir new

```
alish@alish:~$ mkdir new
alish@alish:~$ ls new/
alish@alish:~$
```

5. rmdir(remove directory)

Used to delete a empty folder or directory

Command : rmdir new

```
alish@alish:~$ rmdir new/
alish@alish:~$ ls new
ls: cannot access 'new': No such file or directory
alish@alish:~$
```

6. touch

Create a new empty file also used to update the timestamp of a existing of file.

Command: touch hello.txt

```
alish@alish:~$ mkdir new
alish@alish:~$ cd new/
alish@alish:~/new$ touch hello.txt
alish@alish:~/new$ ls
hello.txt
alish@alish:~/new$
```

7. cp(copy)

Copy files or folder from one location to another

Command : cp hello.txt into.txt

```
alish@alish:~/new$ cp hello.txt into.txt
alish@alish:~/new$ ls
hello.txt  into.txt
alish@alish:~/new$
```

8. mv(move)

Move file or folder from one location to another

Command: mv ~/source ~/destination

```
alish@alish:~$ mkdir new1
alish@alish:~$ mv ~/new/hello.txt ~/new1/
alish@alish:~$ cd new1
alish@alish:~/new1$ ls
hello.txt
alish@alish:~/new1$
```

9. Rm(remove)

Delete the files and its content

Command – rm filename

– rm -r filename or folder_name

```
alish@alish:~/new1$ ls
hello.txt
alish@alish:~/new1$ rm hello.txt
alish@alish:~/new1$ ls
alish@alish:~/new1$
```

10. cat(concatenate)

Displays the entire content of a file on the terminal screen

Command : – cat hello.txt

```
alish@alish:~/new$ cat into.txt
apple
ball
fun
fifa
nepal
happy
messi
banana
spiderman
alish@alish:~/new$
```

11. head

head prints the first line desired by the user (eg head -n)

Command: head -n 4 filename

```
alish@alish:~/new$ head -n 4 into.txt
apple
ball
fun
fifa
alish@alish:~/new$
```

12. tail

tail prints the last line of the file (eg. tail -n)

Command: tail -n 3 filename

```
alish@alish:~/new$ tail -n 3 into.txt
messi
banana
spiderman
alish@alish:~/new$
```

13. less

Unlike cat shows content of a file , less opens the file in an interactive file and you can scroll the content from mouse or arrow key of keyboard

Command : less filename

```
apple
ball
fun
fifa
nepal
happy
messi
banana
spiderman
into.txt (END)
```

```
alish@alish: ~/new
apple
ball
fun
fifa
nepal
happy
messi
banana
spiderman
```

14. grep (Global Regular Expression Print)

Grep is a powerful tool used to search text or pattern from file often used with pip | to filter out the output commands

Command : cat into.txt | grep "fifa"

```
alish@alish:~/new$ cat into.txt | grep "fifa"
fifa
alish@alish:~/new$ cat into.txt | grep -n "fifa"
4:fifa
alish@alish:~/new$
```

15. chmod

This command modifies the access permissions of a file or directory. In Linux, permissions are divided into **Read (r)**, **Write (w)**, and **Execute (x)** for the **User**, **Group**, and **Others**.

Command : chmod 754 into.txt

```
alish@alish:~/new$ chmod 754 into.txt
alish@alish:~/new$ ls -l into.txt
-rwxr-xr-- 1 alish alish 57 Mar 19 21:45 into.txt
alish@alish:~/new$
```

16. chown (Change Owner)

chown is used to change the owner or the group ownership of a file. This is a critical command for system administration when moving files between different user accounts.

Command : sudo chown alish:alish into.txt

```
alish@alish:~/new$ sudo chown alish:alish into.txt
alish@alish:~/new$ ls -l into.txt
-rwxr-xr-- 1 alish alish 57 Mar 19 21:45 into.txt
alish@alish:~/new$
```

17. sudo (SuperUser Do)

sudo allows a permitted user to execute a command as the superuser (root) or another user. It is the gatekeeper for tasks that require administrative privileges, like installing software or editing system files.

Command: cd /etc/sudoers.d

```
alish@alish:~$ cd /etc/sudoers.d/
alish@alish:/etc/sudoers.d$ ls
README
alish@alish:/etc/sudoers.d$ cat README
cat: README: Permission denied
```

18. top

The top command provides a dynamic, real-time view of a running system. It displays system summary information and a list of processes currently being managed by the Linux kernel.

Command: top

```
alish@alish:~$ top

top - 22:19:22 up 3:38, 1 user, load average: 1.40, 1.42, 1.29
Tasks: 275 total, 1 running, 272 sleeping, 2 stopped, 0 zombie
%Cpu(s): 9.6 us, 2.9 sy, 0.0 ni, 21.5 id, 66.0 wa, 0.0 hi, 0.0 si, 0.0 st
MiB Mem : 3696.1 total, 214.2 free, 2468.0 used, 1403.0 buff/cache
MiB Swap: 3695.0 total, 1817.4 free, 1877.6 used. 1228.1 avail Mem

  PID USER      PR  NI   VIRT   RES   SHR  S  %CPU  %MEM    TIME+  COMMAND
 6437 alish     20   0   56.7g 180824 53024 S   12.2   4.8   28:25.36 editors+
19629 alish     20   0   56.7g 233480 66044 S   11.9   6.2   14:17.18 editors+
 4982 alish     20   0 4675476 129680 56624 S    8.9   3.4   10:00.68 gnome-s+
14937 alish     20   0 709872  51972 36056 S    7.3   1.4    0:39.78 gnome-t+
```

19. df (Disk Free)

This command displays the amount of disk space available on the file systems. It helps you monitor how much storage is being used by your hard drives or partitions.

Command: df & df -h

```
alish@alish:~$ df

Filesystem      1K-blocks      Used Available Use% Mounted on
tmpfs           378476         2564    375912   1% /run
/dev/sda2       478512880 89738444 364393868  20% /
tmpfs           1892376        20380    1871996   2% /dev/shm
tmpfs           5120             8        5112   1% /run/lock
efivarfs         24             13           7  65% /sys/firmware/efi/efivars
/dev/sda1       1098628         6288    1092340   1% /boot/efi
tmpfs           378472         152    378320   1% /run/user/1000

alish@alish:~$
```

```
alish@alish:~$ df -h

Filesystem      Size  Used Avail Use% Mounted on
tmpfs           370M  2.6M  368M   1% /run
/dev/sda2       457G   86G  348G  20% /
tmpfs           1.9G   20M  1.8G   2% /dev/shm
tmpfs           5.0M   8.0K  5.0M   1% /run/lock
efivarfs        24K   13K   6.7K  65% /sys/firmware/efi/efivars
/dev/sda1       1.1G   6.2M  1.1G   1% /boot/efi
tmpfs           370M  152K  370M   1% /run/user/1000

alish@alish:~$
```

20. ping:

Checks the connectivity between your machine and a remote host or IP address.

Command : ping <ipconfig>

```
alish@alish:~$ ping 8.8.8.8
PING 8.8.8.8 (8.8.8.8) 56(84) bytes of data.
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=1 ttl=115 time=33.6 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=2 ttl=115 time=39.0 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=3 ttl=115 time=32.8 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=4 ttl=115 time=33.5 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=5 ttl=115 time=50.8 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=6 ttl=115 time=1238 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=7 ttl=115 time=262 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=8 ttl=115 time=30.9 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=9 ttl=115 time=33.4 ms
64 bytes from 8.8.8.8: icmp_seq=10 ttl=115 time=32.1 ms
```

21. nslookup (Name Service Lookup)

This command is used to query Domain Name System (DNS) details. It helps you find the IP address associated with a domain name or find the domain name associated with an IP address.

Command: nslook <name or ip>

```
alish@alish:~$ nslookup  instagram.com
Server:          127.0.0.53
Address:         127.0.0.53#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   instagram.com
Address: 57.144.48.34
Name:   instagram.com
Address: 2a03:2880:f311:22:face:b00c:0:4420

alish@alish:~$
```